

ENG522 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 03

(ENG522) Applied Linguistics

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Lesson 01

Introduction to Applied Linguistics

Introduction to Applied Linguistics

What is the definition of Applied Linguistics according to the International Association of Applied Linguistics (AILA)?

AILA defines Applied Linguistics as an interdisciplinary field that deals with practical language and communication problems using linguistic theories, methods, and results, or by developing new theoretical and methodological frameworks.

What are some areas that Applied Linguistics can encompass, as mentioned in the AILA definition?

Applied Linguistics can include areas such as child language acquisition, language and communication disorders, multilingualism, language testing, communication in the workplace, and more.

What are the seven different ways of looking at language, as presented by Ron Macaulay?

The seven ways of looking at language are language as meaning, sound, form, communication, identity, history, and symbol.

How does the conceptualization of language affect the methodological perspectives in linguistics?

Different conceptualizations of language lead to various methodological perspectives in linguistics, influencing how linguists gather and analyze evidence. This diversity characterizes the different branches and sub-branches of linguistics.

What distinguishes the first schematized approach to linguistics (Figure 1.1) from the second approach (Figure 1.2)?

The first approach relies on the linguist's intuition and knowledge of the language without separately collected data. In contrast, the second approach uses a database for analysis, which can be derived from the language users.

What are the key implications for Applied Linguists discussed in the text?

The key implications for Applied Linguists are:

1. Applied Linguists need to be multidisciplinary and have knowledge in various areas.
2. Applied Linguists act as consultants, providing advice and interpretation but leaving the final decision to the client.
3. Describing language, on its own, is not considered Applied Linguistics unless it contributes to problem-solving.

How does Applied Linguistics differ from descriptive linguistics?

Applied Linguistics focuses on solving real-world language problems, while descriptive linguistics primarily concerns the analysis and description of language without an immediate problem-solving objective.

What is the unique selling point of Applied Linguistics that distinguishes it from other disciplines, according to the text?

The unique selling point of Applied Linguistics is its central focus on language. It distinguishes itself from other disciplines by dealing with language-related problems and research that are relevant to language practice.

The Black English Trial in Ann Arbor (Labov, 1982)

What is the significance of the Ann Arbor case in 1977?

The Ann Arbor case was significant as it raised questions about the educational failure of black children in the United States, particularly related to their language and the so-called "restricted code."

Why did linguists become involved in the Ann Arbor case?

Linguists became involved to provide testimony and evidence about the linguistic facts and challenges faced by black children, as their language was central to the case.

What linguistic features characterized Black English Vernacular (BEV)?

BEV included features such as the zero form of the possessive, habitual be, absence of 3rd person singular "s," and more.

Labov's Principles and the Trial Outcome

What principles did Labov enunciate regarding social action?

Labov outlined principles like "error correction" and "obligation" for scientists involved in social action, emphasizing the responsibility to share important data with the public.

Why was it essential for linguists to present a united front during the trial?

Linguists needed to present a united front to ensure a consensus on linguistic issues, which was crucial for the trial's success.

The Role of Applied Linguists and Career Opportunities

What distinguishes Applied Linguistics as a methodology?

Applied Linguistics focuses on real-world language problems, making it a methodology that emphasizes practical problem-solving.

What are some potential career opportunities for graduates with a background in Applied Linguistics?

Career opportunities include roles such as language teachers, language education experts, speech pathologists, translators/interpreters, and more.

Defining Research Questions and Literature Review

What is the purpose of a literature review in the research process?

Answer: A literature review helps researchers understand existing work, prepare their arguments, and identify research gaps and questions.

How does a critical literature review help in the research process?

A critical literature review assesses the strengths and weaknesses of existing studies, compares results, and helps formulate specific research questions.

Research Design

What is the primary consideration when designing a research project?

The primary consideration is determining what type of evidence is needed to answer the research question convincingly.

What are the main types of research design mentioned in the text?

The main types of research design mentioned are etic vs. emic, quantitative vs. qualitative, experimental vs. non-experimental, longitudinal vs. non-longitudinal, and case study vs. group study.

What distinguishes an etic study from an emic study?

An etic study is comparative, while an emic study explores patterns and meanings in situ.

How does quantitative research differ from qualitative research?

Quantitative research collects and analyzes data numerically, while qualitative research focuses on the meaning of the phenomenon and does not involve numerical data.

In an experimental design, what is the purpose of 'control'?

In an experimental design, 'control' is used to keep everything, except for the variables under investigation, as similar or comparable as possible.

What is the key difference between longitudinal and cross-sectional designs?

Longitudinal designs collect data from a small number of subjects over a period of time, while cross-sectional designs collect data at one point in time from a large number of subjects grouped by specific variables.

When is a case study design typically used?

A case study design is typically used for an in-depth investigation of a single subject.

How is critical research different from other types of research?

Critical research involves a critique of societal and cultural issues, focusing on local manifestations and rejecting the idea of an 'objective depiction.'

Data Collection

What are the two broad categories of data that Applied Linguists are interested in?

The two categories are interactional data and non-interactional data.

How is interactional data different from non-interactional data?

Interactional data consists of language in interaction, while non-interactional data is about language practices and includes surveys, questionnaires, and interviews.

What is the key issue when working with interactional data obtained through elicitation?

The key issue is ensuring the comparability of elicited conversation to naturally occurring interaction.

How is ethnography different from other data collection techniques?

Ethnography is a holistic approach that explores the meaning of a phenomenon and often requires in situ observation.

Analysing and Presentation Findings

How are quantitative data typically presented?

Quantitative data are often presented through statistics and various figures, tables, graphs, and diagrams.

How are qualitative data typically presented?

Qualitative data are usually presented in discursive accounts with quotations and samples of actual data.

What is essential when analyzing and presenting data?

Accuracy and accountability are essential in data analysis and presentation, including transparency about the researcher's perspective and expectations.

Ethical Considerations

What is the importance of justifying a research project?

A research project should achieve worthwhile objectives, and the benefits should outweigh the risks, ensuring participants' welfare and public responsibility.

What does informed consent involve?

Informed consent involves fully informing participants about the project's aim, potential risks, and their rights, such as the right to withdraw or refuse to answer questions.

Why is cross-cultural differences in ethics relevant to Applied Linguistics studies?

Cross-cultural differences in ethics are relevant because they can exist between the culture where the research is conducted and the culture of the participants, particularly in intercultural studies, requiring clarification and anticipation of potential differences.

Comparative Study of Research Designs

What is the goal of comparing these studies?

To compare the way the researchers ask questions and design the studies.

What should be analyzed in these studies?

The differences in how questions are asked, study designs, and the justifications for them.

Mixed Research Design

What kind of study is mentioned in study activity 1.2?

A study that uses a mixed design, e.g., longitudinal and cross-sectional, quantitative and qualitative.

What is the added value of a mixed design?

It reveals aspects that a single design cannot uncover.

How does the researcher handle contradictions in findings from different research designs?

Interpret the contradictions and provide explanations.

Observational Study and Ethical Considerations

What type of study does study activity 1.2 suggest conducting?

An observational study in an everyday situation.

How can one's identity affect the observation process?

It can influence the relationship with the people observed, perspective, and

interpretation.

What ethical considerations are important for this study?

Ethical issues related to observation and research.

Ethical Guidelines and Resources

What is recommended for students regarding ethical approval?

To seek approval from an ethics committee before data collection.

Name one professional body that provides ethical guidelines for Applied Linguistics.

British Association for Applied Linguistics (BAAL).

Where can you find TESOL Quarterly Research Guidelines?

They are available at www.tesol.org/.

Structure and Content of the Volume

What is the main aim of the volume in study activity 1.4?

To introduce the field of Applied Linguistics comprehensively.

How is this textbook different from traditional introductory textbooks?

It's a team-authored text that highlights multiple voices in the field.

How many parts is the volume divided into, and can you name them?

The volume is divided into four main parts: Language Development, Language in Use, Language in Society, and Language in Public Life.

Recommended Reading

Name two handbooks that provide comprehensive surveys of Applied Linguistics.

"Handbook of Applied Linguistics" and "The Oxford Handbook of Applied Linguistics."

Name a book recommended for a concise overview of the central issues in Applied Linguistics.

"Applied Linguistics" by Guy Cook.

Mention two introductory texts on research methods in Applied Linguistics.

"Research Methods in Applied Linguistics: quantitative, qualitative, and Mixed Methodologies" by Zoltán Dörnyei and "The Research Manual: Design and Statistics for Applied Linguistics" by Evelyn Hatch and Anne Lazaraton.

Lesson 02

First Language Acquisition

Topic 2.1: Introduction

Who is Dominic, and what is his language background?

Dominic is a four-year-old boy born and raised in Bonn, Germany. He comes from a monolingual German-speaking family, and he and his two brothers speak only German.

Who is Mia, and what is her language background?

Mia is a two-year-old girl adopted by English-speaking parents in California. She was adopted from an orphanage in China at the age of 19 months.

What is Diego's linguistic background?

Diego is a two-year-old boy born in Paraguay. His father speaks Spanish and Guarani, while his mother, originally from Taiwan, speaks Mandarin, Taiwanese, and Spanish. He is exposed to multiple languages from birth.

What are the main questions this chapter aims to explore?

This chapter aims to explore how children, in monolingual or multilingual contexts, acquire their first language(s) and how the language environment impacts their acquisition.

Topic 2.2: What Are the Facts and Problems of First Language Acquisition**What drives children to learn and speak the languages spoken around them?**

The need to communicate and socialize drives children to learn and speak the languages spoken around them.

What are some developmental stages in language acquisition often seen in children?

Developmental stages include pre-speech and babbling, first words, combining words into sentences, complex sentences, and conversational skills.

What is the "projection problem" or the "logical problem of language acquisition"?

It's the challenge children face in learning to produce adult-like utterances despite not receiving optimal input. They need to develop competence and performance.

What is "Universal Grammar" in the generative paradigm?

Universal Grammar (UG) is a set of universal principles underlying the structure of all human languages. It restricts the set of grammars that are compatible with input, aiding children in generalizing about the target grammar.

What is the "bootstrapping account" in language acquisition?

It's the idea that children "bootstrap" or break into the target language system to start the acquisition process. They attend to specific linguistic cues in the input.

What are the key tensions between the generative paradigm and alternative theories?

The tensions revolve around whether there is an innate, language-specific

capacity and the role of input in language acquisition.

Study Activity 2.1

In the study activity, what does the child initially say about the object?

The child says, "There is a fiss in there."

How does the father correct the child's statement in the study activity?

The father corrects the child by saying, "You mean there's a fish in there."

What does this study activity demonstrate about the child's speech?

The activity shows that the child initially makes a pronunciation error by saying "fiss" instead of "fish," and the father corrects the child's error.

How Do Adults Speak to Children and What Roles Does Input Play in Language Acquisition

What is Chomsky's concept of innateness, and what problem does it address in language acquisition?

Chomsky's concept of innateness highlights the "poverty of stimuli," which refers to the lack of both positive and negative evidence in the speech that children are exposed to during language acquisition.

What is child-directed speech (CDS), and how does it differ from normal speech?

Child-directed speech (CDS) is speech directed to young children by caregivers, such as mothers, fathers, or older siblings. It differs from normal speech in syntax, vocabulary, phonology, speed, prosody, and communicative clarity.

What are some key characteristics of CDS compared to adult-directed speech?

CDS is simpler in syntax, vocabulary, and phonology.

It focuses on the child's interests, such as actions, objects, and people.

CDS is semantically related to the child's language, using repetition, expansion, and recasting.

It includes phatic responses like "yes" and "I see."

CDS encourages meaningful contributions from the child.

It uses naturally occurring conversational slots.

How do adults fine-tune CDS for children, and what factors influence this fine-tuning?

Fine-tuning of CDS is influenced by the child's age, language ability, and social/cultural norms. Prosodic fine-tuning, phonetic/phonological fine-tuning, and syntactic fine-tuning are common. Fine-tuning is more directive for children with atypical language development.

What is the role of negotiation in child-directed speech (CDS)?

At the heart of CDS is negotiation between caregivers and children. Adults adjust their speech based on a child's responses and age. This negotiation ensures

effective communication.

What is the significance of input in language acquisition?

Input is essential for language acquisition. It provides the linguistic environment for children to learn a language. However, the exact role of input is still not fully understood.

How does input influence language acquisition according to the two different views mentioned in the text?

There are two views: input as a trigger or catapult and input as a source of opportunities for incremental learning. Both suggest input is crucial but cannot fully explain its impact on language development.

What is code-switching, and why is it common in bilingual and multilingual children?

Code-switching is the alternation of languages in speech. It is common in bilingual and multilingual children because they have the capacity to coordinate two languages according to grammatical constraints.

What is the main difference between monolingual and bilingual/multilingual first language acquisition?

The main difference is that bilingual/multilingual children often use code-switching in their speech and may not develop both languages equally well, leading to variations in language comprehension and production.

How do the languages being acquired interact or interfere with each other in bilingual and multilingual first language acquisition?

The languages may interact through transfer, acceleration, delay, or interlanguage structural ambiguity, which is influenced by linguistic relatedness and input.

What is the role of input in bilingual and multilingual first language acquisition, and what challenges and benefits do these children face?

Input plays a crucial role in language acquisition for bilingual and multilingual children, but its impact and challenges are complex and not fully understood. These children can achieve high proficiency in multiple languages despite limited input, but the quality of input is essential.

Cross-linguistic Studies in First Language Acquisition

What are cross-linguistic studies in the context of first language acquisition?

Cross-linguistic studies explore language development across different languages and their impact on first language acquisition.

How do cross-linguistic studies contribute to our understanding of language acquisition?

They help identify developmental universals and language-specific patterns in

language acquisition.

What was Jakobson's claim about phonological development and language universals?

Jakobson claimed that certain sounds, like nasals and front consonants, are acquired early due to their prevalence in world languages.

How has Jakobson's claim on phonological development been challenged?

Counterexamples showed individual variations within languages and language variations in the acquisition of specific sounds.

What is the universal noun bias in lexicon development, and how has it been challenged?

The universal noun bias suggests that nouns are acquired first, but studies in various languages have challenged this idea.

In syntax acquisition, what was the early claim about general word order, and how has it been challenged?

The early claim was that children may start with a general word order, but cross-linguistic studies have shown that children generally follow the basic word order of their specific languages.

What is the 'pro-drop parameter setting' hypothesis, and how has it been challenged?

The hypothesis suggests children may universally believe that sentence subjects can be omitted, but a study on Japanese-speaking children and comparative studies have challenged this idea.

Language Socialization and Its Impact on Language Acquisition

What is language socialization, and how does it affect language acquisition?

Language socialization is the process through which individuals learn to speak a language in a way that aligns with the beliefs and norms of their community, impacting language acquisition and use.

What are the four different ways in which language socialization takes place?

Explicit instruction, implicit instruction, explicit learning of norms, beliefs, and values, and implicit influence.

How does language socialization reflect cultural and interpersonal dimensions?

It demonstrates how different cultures influence language use, social norms, and values, and how individuals learn to communicate appropriately within their communities.

What role do children play in the process of language development according to recent studies?

Children are not passive recipients but actively shape their own learning

experiences, participating in identity formation and impacting the linguistic resources of their communities.

How does language socialization relate to the concept of input in language development?

Language socialization emphasizes that input is not just about linguistic support but also about making children aware of the sociocultural appropriateness of their language and social behavior.

Summary of First Language Acquisition

What does the study of first language acquisition focus on?

It investigates how children acquire their mother tongue(s) and the role of input in language development.

How is first language acquisition different from second language acquisition?

First language acquisition pertains to children learning their mother tongue(s), while second language acquisition involves learning an additional language.

How does language socialization integrate with language development?

It shows that language development and social development are interconnected processes, emphasizing the role of communication and socialization in language acquisition.

Lesson 03

Second and Additional Language Acquisition

Topic 3.1: Introduction

Who is the main character in Pascal Mercier's novel "Night Train to Lisbon"?

The main character is Raimund Gregorius, an erudite Swiss-German teacher.

What event sparks Gregorius's passion for Portuguese?

He encounters a mysterious woman about to jump off a bridge who speaks Portuguese as her mother tongue.

How does Gregorius overcome his communicative anxiety in Portuguese?

He buys language learning materials, listens to a Portuguese language course, and repeats sentences to improve his pronunciation.

3.2: What Makes Somebody a 'Good Language Learner'?

Is there a profile for a 'good language learner'?

Researchers have attempted to create such a profile, but it remains elusive.

How do some learners differ in their language learning progress despite similar

personality profiles?

It's because external factors and "trigger events" play a significant role in language learning.

3.2.1: Multicompetence

What is multicompetence, and how does it affect language learners?

Multicompetence is when learners use multiple languages. It can alter their cognitive representation of languages and categories.

How do multilingual individuals differ in personality traits compared to monolinguals?

Multilingual individuals often score higher on personality dimensions like Openmindedness and Cultural Empathy.

3.2.2: Motivation

What is the role of motivation in second language acquisition?

Motivation is a critical factor in language learning, and it can influence a learner's success in acquiring a new language.

How can motivation and language anxiety affect language learning performance?

Higher motivation and lower language anxiety are often associated with better language learning performance.

3.2.3: Motivation as a Dynamic System

What criticism has Gardner's model faced regarding motivation?

Motivation levels have been shown to vary constantly, even during a language class.

According to Dörnyei, what distinction needs to be made in motivational processes?

Different levels of motivational processes, some linked to the enduring social context, while others are more localized.

What term does Dörnyei suggest abandoning, and what does he propose focusing on?

Abandon "integrative motivation" and focus more on the "L2 Motivational Self System."

How does Dörnyei relate the "Ideal L2 Self" to "integrative motivation"?

The "Ideal L2 Self" is equated with "integrative motivation," where a learner's ideal self is proficient in the L2.

3.2.4: Epistemological Choices

What are the advantages of an etic, quantitative research approach in attitude and motivation research?

It is systematic, rigorous, focused, and tightly controlled, producing reliable and replicable data.

What limitation does an etic, quantitative approach have in research on motivation?

It has limited general exploratory capacity and restricts participants from sharing potentially relevant information.

What is an emic approach in research, and how does it differ from the etic approach?

An emic approach involves considering participants' opinions and is typically based on qualitative methods, providing a broader range of possible interpretations.

3.2.5: Summary

What does recent research suggest about the stability of motivation levels in language learners?

Motivation levels are dynamic, and other factors may cancel out positive motivation.

What does the text propose about the concept of a "good language learner"?

The category "good language learner" may depend on various life events and is not a stable trait.

How does the text liken becoming a "good language learner" to falling in love?

Like falling in love, it's impossible to predict but can lead to newfound freedom and exhilaration.

3.3: Age Effects and the Critical Period Hypothesis

How is the Critical Period Hypothesis (CPH) defined?

The CP is defined as the age beyond which it becomes difficult to fully acquire a language, particularly in terms of grammar and pronunciation.

What core idea is associated with the CPH?

The core idea is that "automatic acquisition from mere exposure" seems to disappear after a certain age.

What did research on the CPH by Johnson and Newport (1989) reveal about the age of onset of acquisition (AoA)?

Younger starters obtained higher scores on grammaticality judgment tasks, with a strong negative correlation between AoA and proficiency in the young group.

What does DeKeyser argue about the age of onset of language learning?

He argues that a low AoA confers an absolute advantage, with a critical period somewhere between the ages of 6 and 17.

3.3.2: Possible Neurobiological Causes for Age Effects

According to Paradis, why do age effects occur in language learning?

Age effects are caused by the decline of procedural memory for late L2 learners, forcing them to rely on explicit learning.

In what order does Paradis suggest different language components are acquired?

Prosody precedes phonology, followed by morphology and syntax, while vocabulary is not susceptible to age effects.

3.3.3: CPH and Learning Context

How does the age of onset effect (AoA) vary between naturalistic and formal language learning contexts?

AoA effects are robust in naturalistic contexts but weaker in formal classroom settings.

What do Muñoz's findings suggest about the optimal age to start learning an L3 in a classroom?

Earlier exposure (ages eight to nine) did not result in better performance, but the length of exposure had a positive effect.

3.3.4: Summary

What do most researchers agree on regarding age effects in SLA?

Younger starters in naturalistic contexts tend to outperform older starters, but there is disagreement on the existence of cut-off points.

How does the text relate the concept of a "critical period" to Gregorius' language learning journey?

The text speculates whether Gregorius would have made quicker progress if he had started at a younger age and discusses the hypothetical role of the critical period.

3.4: Previously Learned Languages

3.4.1 Stepping Stones

What is Cummins's Developmental Interdependence hypothesis?

It suggests that a high level of proficiency in the first language is an advantage in second language learning.

How does literacy in both languages affect bilinguals' third language learning?

Literacy skills in both languages are necessary for significant positive effects in third language learning.

What are some benefits of knowing more languages according to research?

Knowing more languages is linked to faster grammar grasping, a stronger inclination to study foreign languages, and increased metalinguistic awareness.

3.4.2 Non-Linguistic Effects

What nonverbal control tasks have bilingual children been found to outperform monolingual peers in?

Bilingual children outperform in tasks like the 'Simon task.'

What is the reason behind bilingual children's superior performance in nonverbal tasks?

Their performance is linked to the continuous activation of two languages and their ability to switch between them.

How does knowledge of more languages affect foreign language anxiety?

Adults knowing more languages tend to suffer less from foreign language anxiety.

3.4.4 Cross-linguistic Influences

What factors can affect L2 learners' reliance on previously learned languages?

Language distance, target language proficiency, source language proficiency, recency of use, length of residence, and formality of context can affect reliance on previously learned languages.

What are the main distinctions between explicit and implicit language teaching approaches?

The explicit approach emphasizes accuracy and grammar knowledge, while the implicit approach focuses on communication, meaning, and inductive learning.

3.5: Instructional Environments and Authentic Use

3.5.1 Types of Instructional Environment

How does the prominence of the target language outside the classroom affect L2 learning?

Learners in contexts where the target language is widely used outside the classroom tend to outperform those in contexts where it's less prominent.

What is the main distinction between explicit and implicit language teaching approaches?

The explicit approach emphasizes accuracy and grammar knowledge, while the implicit approach focuses on communication, meaning, and inductive learning.

What does the Input Hypothesis propose in terms of L2 acquisition?

The Input Hypothesis suggests that L2 is acquired through exposure to "comprehensible input."

What does research suggest about the effectiveness of explicit versus implicit learning?

Some research shows that explicit learning can have advantages in terms of accuracy and development in the L2.

3.5.2: The Nature of Learners' Linguistic Knowledge

What is explicit knowledge in the context of SLA research?

Explicit knowledge is knowledge that a person knows they possess and can use intentionally, such as consciously knowing grammar rules.

How is implicit knowledge defined in SLA research?

Implicit knowledge is knowledge that a person has without awareness of having it and is deployed automatically, like using language fluently.

Which brain regions support explicit knowledge, and which support implicit knowledge?

Implicit knowledge is rooted in the frontal and basal ganglia, while explicit knowledge is rooted in the medial and lateral temporal lobe structures.

Why is operationalizing implicit knowledge challenging in SLA research?

Implicit knowledge relies on assessing subjective mental states, such as awareness, which can be difficult to measure.

What's the distinction between explicit and implicit knowledge, and are they related?

Some researchers argue that explicit knowledge can become implicit through practice, suggesting a connection between the two.

3.5.3: The Transition From L2 Learner to L2 User

What speech style do L2 learners who acquire their L2 through formal instruction tend to use initially?

They tend to choose a speech style in the middle of the continuum, which can make them sound too formal when speaking and too informal when writing.

What is monostylistic L2 repertoire, and why does it happen?

Monostylistic L2 repertoire is when L2 learners use one sociolinguistic variant categorically. This occurs due to limited exposure to diverse linguistic input in the early stages.

When do L2 learners start to explore more formal and informal speech styles?

L2 learners gradually start exploring both ends of the speech style continuum as they become L2 users.

What factors influence the alternation between sociolinguistic variants in L2 users?

Factors such as exposure, social networks, and immersion in the target language community influence alternation between sociolinguistic variants.

In what situations might L2 users consciously decide not to adopt certain variation patterns from the target language community?

L2 users might avoid adopting such patterns if they conflict with their cultural beliefs or sense of self, or if they feel it would have unwanted effects, such as signaling "in-group" membership.

3.5.4: Summary

What role does the instructional environment play in the development of learners' interlanguages?

The instructional environment plays a significant role in the development of interlanguages, affecting grammar, fluency, and various aspects of language use.

How does the type of teaching approach affect different aspects of interlanguages?

Teaching approaches vary from implicit, inductive communicative approaches that focus on fluency to explicit instruction methods that emphasize accuracy.

What benefits do L2 learners gain from authentic use of the target language in communicative situations?

Authentic use of the target language benefits not only grammatical skills but also sociolinguistic, sociocultural, and pragmatic competence.

How does immersion in the target language community affect L2 users?

Immersion in the target language community leads to the development of sociolinguistic and pragmatic competence and encourages users to reflect on identity and beliefs.

What is the main takeaway from this chapter on factors influencing SLA and language use?

Various psychological, biographical, instructional, and social factors influence the successful acquisition and use of second or foreign languages.

3.6: Conclusion

What are some key factors that "good" language learners have in common?

"Good" language learners share a positive attitude toward the language, motivation, passion, and dedication to overcome challenges in mastering the language.

Is there a clear age at which it becomes impossible to reach native speaker levels in a second language?

While there are age effects in SLA, no clear cut-off points have been established, and some late starters can reach native-speaker levels in certain tasks.

How does multilingualism affect the acquisition of a new language?

Multilinguals tend to have an advantage in acquiring new languages due to their "meta"-understanding of various language aspects, making them more confident communicators and learners.

What are the cognitive aspects of SLA and multilingualism related to?

Cognitive aspects are related to the instructional context and the nature of linguistic knowledge (implicit or explicit), as well as its location in the brain.

What is the main impact of immersion in a foreign language society on linguistic skills?

Immersion in a foreign language society positively impacts sociolinguistic and pragmatic competence and encourages self-reflection.

Working on the Next Lessons

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